

ΔΗΜΟΚΡΙΤΕΙΟ ΠΑΝΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΙΟ ΘΡΑΚΗΣ
Σχολή Κοινωνικών Πολιτικών και Οικονομικών Επιστημών
Τμήμα Οικονομικών Επιστημών



ΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΟΝΙΚΗ ΔΙΗΜΕΡΙΔΑ ΤΜΗΜΑΤΟΣ ΟΙΚΟΝΟΜΙΚΩΝ ΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΩΝ

ΚΟΜΟΤΗΝΗ
16-17 ΟΚΤΩΒΡΙΟΥ 2020

ΤΟΜΟΣ ΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΟΝΙΚΩΝ ΣΥΜΒΟΛΩΝ

ΟΡΓΑΝΩΣΗ ΤΟΥ ΤΟΜΟΥ ΠΡΑΚΤΙΚΩΝ ΔΙΗΜΕΡΙΔΑΣ

Ιωάννης Ντόκας

Επίκουρος Καθηγητής Τμήματος Οικονομικών Επιστημών ΔΠΘ

Κωνσταντίνος Χαζάκης

Καθηγητής, Πρόεδρος Τμήματος Οικονομικών Επιστημών ΔΠΘ



ΕΚΔΟΣΕΙΣ ΠΑΠΑΖΗΣΗ

**ΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΟΝΙΚΗ ΔΙΗΜΕΡΙΔΑ
ΤΜΗΜΑΤΟΣ ΟΙΚΟΝΟΜΙΚΩΝ ΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΩΝ
16-17 ΟΚΤΩΒΡΙΟΥ 2020**

Εκδόσεις ΠΑΠΑΖΗΣΗ ΑΕΒΕ

Επιστημονική Διημερίδα Τμήματος Οικονομικών Επιστημών
Ιωάννης Ντόκας, Κωνσταντίνος Χαζάκης (οργάνωση)

ISBN: 978-960-02-3828-0

Copyright © 2021:

Εκδόσεις ΠΑΠΑΖΗΣΗ ΑΕΒΕ

Νικηταρά 2 & Εμμ. Μπενάκη, 106 78 Αθήνα

Τηλ.: 210-38 22 496, 210-38 38 020

Fax: 210-38 09 150

site: www.papazisi.gr

e-mail: papazisi@otenet.gr

Υποκατάστημα Θεσσαλονίκης

Σιατίστης 7, 54 631

Τηλ.: 2310-227410

e-mail: natasapelagidou@papazisi.gr

Εκτύπωση-Βιβλοδεσία:

grafima media | creative | pr!nt

Λ. Ελευθερίας 29 (Αμφιθέας), Άλιμος Τ.Κ. 174 55

Τηλ. Κέντρο: 210 72 51 600, Fax: 210 72 51 605

grafimaprint.gr

Απαγορεύεται η μερική ή ολική αναδημοσίευση του έργου αυτού, καθώς και η αναπαραγωγή του με οποιοδήποτε μέσο χωρίς σχετική άδεια του Εκδότη

ΔΗΜΟΚΡΕΤΕΙΟ ΠΑΝΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΙΟ ΘΡΑΚΗΣ
Σχολή Κοινωνικών Πολιτικών και Οικονομικών Επιστημών
Τμήμα Οικονομικών Επιστημών

ΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΟΝΙΚΗ ΔΙΗΜΕΡΙΔΑ
ΤΜΗΜΑΤΟΣ ΟΙΚΟΝΟΜΙΚΩΝ ΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΩΝ
16-17 ΟΚΤΩΒΡΙΟΥ 2020
ΚΟΜΟΤΗΝΗ

ΤΟΜΟΣ
ΕΠΙΣΤΗΜΟΝΙΚΩΝ ΣΥΜΒΟΛΩΝ

ΟΡΓΑΝΩΣΗ ΤΟΥ ΤΟΜΟΥ ΠΡΑΚΤΙΚΩΝ ΔΙΗΜΕΡΙΔΑΣ

Ιωάννης Ντόκας

Επίκουρος Καθηγητής Τμήματος Οικονομικών Επιστημών ΔΠΘ

Κωνσταντίνος Χαζάκης

Καθηγητής, Πρόεδρος Τμήματος Οικονομικών Επιστημών ΔΠΘ



ΕΚΔΟΣΕΙΣ ΠΑΠΑΖΗΣΗ
ΑΘΗΝΑ 2021

*Ευχαριστούμε τις εκδόσεις Παπαζήση
για την έκδοση των πρακτικών της διημερίδας*

ΠΕΡΙΕΧΟΜΕΝΑ

Αντί Προλόγου	11
COVID-19 pandemic crisis: Accelerator or decelerator of the new globalization?. <i>Dimos Chatzinikolaou, Charis Vlado, Theodore Koutroukis</i>	13
Πρόγνωση της Ανεργίας στην Ευρωζώνη με Μεθόδους Μηχανικής Μάθησης. <i>Εμμανουήλ Σοφινός, Περικλής Γκόγκας, Θεόφιλος Παπαδημητρίου</i>	25
Εμπειρική διερεύνηση των παραγόντων που προσδιορίζουν το μέγεθος των άμεσων ξένων επενδύσεων από την Ελλάδα στα πλαίσια της διεθνούς διοίκησης επιχειρήσεων και της διπλωματίας. <i>Βασίλειος Βλάχος, Κωνσταντίνος Χαζάκης</i>	43
Entrepreneurship and innovation enhancement policies in the micro-meso and the macro level: A preliminary review <i>Dimos Chatzinikolaou, Charis Vlado, Theodore Koutroukis</i>	51
Regional and less developed business ecosystems: Strategies and development prospects <i>Fotios Katimertzopoulos, Charis Vlado, Theodore Koutroukis</i>	61
Σχεδιασμός και υλοποίηση κοινωνικής πολιτικής στις λιγότερο ανεπτυγμένες περιφέρειες της Ελλάδας: Οι επιπτώσεις της οικονομικής ύφεσης <i>Σημέλα Χατζηκωνσταντινίδου, Ευάγγελος Δρυμπέτας</i>	77

Employee voice in the era of Covid-19 pandemic: A case study of a Greek Municipal small-medium sized Enterprise.	89
<i>Eleni Triantafyllidou, Theodore Koutroukis</i>	
Σύνδεση Δια Βίου Μάθησης με Αγορά εργασίας και Δεξιότητες	103
<i>Ιωάννα Τσάρπα, Θεόδωρος Κουτρούκης</i>	
Η Περιφερειακή Οικονομική Πολιτική της Ε.Ε.: Η περίπτωση της Ανατολικής Μακεδονίας - Θράκης.	115
<i>Διαμαντής Μυρτσίδης</i>	
Βιογραφικό σημείωμα συγγραφέων.	131

ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND INNOVATION ENHANCEMENT POLICIES IN THE MICRO-MESO AND THE MACRO LEVEL: A PRELIMINARY REVIEW

DIMOS CHATZINIKOLAOU

Ph.D Candidate, Department of Economics, Democritus University of Thrace

CHARIS VLADOS

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Democritus University of Thrace

THEODORE KOUTROUKIS

Associate Professor, Department of Economics, Democritus University of Thrace

ABSTRACT

Entrepreneurship and the resulting innovation should be at the developmental epicenter for the different socio-economic systems. By analyzing the various levels of understanding and practical implementation of policies to enhance entrepreneurship and innovation, this article aims at a first classification and categorization of these. This article analyzes the concepts of innovation and entrepreneurship and the classification of policies to stimulate them. We argue that the micro-meso entrepreneurship policy domain is the most decisive because it produces and reproduces knowledge within businesses and today's globalized industries. This knowledge is critical to innovation, especially in the current conditions of the current COVID-19 crisis

where traditional industries lose market shares. This classification of policies to enhance entrepreneurship and innovation is the first step in distinguishing the best practices suggested by the scholarly literature in conjunction with applied examples.

Keywords: *entrepreneurship, innovation, micro-meso, macrolevel, entrepreneurship policy, innovation policy*

1. Introduction

Entrepreneurship is a critical development pillar for all socio-economic systems nowadays. Being aware of the multiple levels of perceiving space in socio-economic sciences at the micro, meso, and macro levels (Dopfer et al., 2004; Vladoš, 2019b), we aim in this article to distinguish and categorize the implementation levels of entrepreneurship enhancement policies. Such a classification would allow for a “benchmarking” of these policies and to figure out which one approaches the standards set out in the international literature. To this end, in section 2, the concepts of entrepreneurship and innovation are analyzed. In section 3, an attempt is being made to classify policies for strengthening them. In section 4, specific results are discussed, pointing to research prospects.

2. Entrepreneurship and innovation

Entrepreneurship means taking risks and creating innovative products and services. In the mainstream economic view, entrepreneurship combines and incorporates labor, capital, and natural resources to produce economic goods and profit (Sloman, 2019). According to Marshall’s (1890) fundamental definition, the entrepreneur deals with the “ordinary business of life,” meaning that changes in the “means of production” do not stop to take place and continuously alter the entire socio-economic system.

The one who laid the foundations for the systematic and evolutionary study of the phenomenon was Schumpeter. According to Schumpeter (1942), the entrepreneur destroys the existing economic equilibrium with innovation, an act of “creative destruction,” where aging industries give way to young industries, leading the socio-economic system towards progress. Therefore, at the heart of the concept of entrepreneurship, there is always the corresponding dynamics of innovation, which means sustainability and competitive advantage by fulfilling customer needs. In the Schumpeterian view (Schumpeter, 1934), entrepreneurial innovations are real revolutions. Innovations are new products or improvements in the production methods, the opening of new markets and the reorganization of entire industries. In a similar vein, most definitions of innovation complement this Schumpeterian stream of thought. For example, innovations for Schmookler (1952) also are novel producing methods or consumer products. Porter (1998) suggests that innovation does not mean incremental improvements but finding novel ways of combining things, while Crossan and Apaydin (2010) similarly view innovation as both a process and an outcome.

All these definitions help us realize that innovation affects all internal and external environments of socio-economic organizations. Therefore, businesses are the productive cells of a modern economy. From a “biological” approach to economics (Geus, 2002; Vladoš, 2019a), all firms are living and evolving organizations, groups of people that aim at achieving common goals and making economic use of the knowledge generated within a society (Figure 1).

The process of innovation takes the pieces of explicit knowledge (technology) by also taking advantage of produced achievements in the form of inventions, implementing them to respond to human needs and taking the risk of market failure. By merely owning any modern technology is quite different from innovating. In this effort, it is always of great significance to manage the available technological potential to generate practical innovations and knowledge (Nonaka & Takeuchi, 1995).

Today, the most critical link in strengthening innovation and entrepreneurship success depends on managing change efficiently. Change management protects the socio-economic organization from the consequences of market innovation transformations and helps it to adapt by understanding

and managing the forces of resistance and regression that inevitably exist in every firm (Burnes, 2009). Especially after the current pandemic crisis of COVID-19 and the acceleration of the fourth industrial revolution, where traditional industries have lost colossal market shares, the promotion and strengthening of the innovative and therefore the adaptive potential of firms must be a priority of policies for strengthening entrepreneurship (OECD, 2020; United Nations, 2020; World Economic Forum, 2020). Exiting any crisis requires improved performance through innovation and management of this multilayered change (Bianchi & Labory, 2012; OECD, 2009b; Vladoš & Chatzinikolaou, 2019b). The next section sets out various levels of entrepreneurship-enhancing policies.

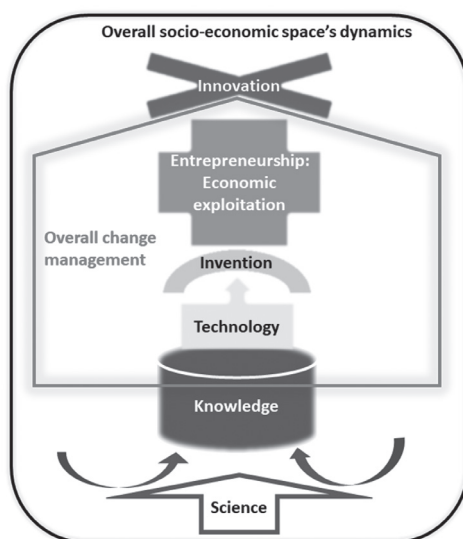


Figure 1. Innovation and economic exploitation. Based on Vladoš (2016).

3. “Pure” and mixed types of entrepreneurship enhancement policies

What should we do to stimulate entrepreneurship and innovation? Various traditions emphasize different things (Howlett, 2009; Mirzanti et al.,

2015). The earliest approaches (the most conventional) argue that if the policy supports the macroeconomic figures to grow, it indirectly benefits entrepreneurship. For example, macroeconomic measures can be the horizontal reduction of taxation or reduced interest rates through monetary policy. An emerging policy approach is also to enhance macrosocial dimensions, including all those related to cognitive, cultural, and natural environments. Reducing bureaucracy, faster administration of justice, and improving educational institutions that give better quality inputs to businesses in the long-term are macrosocial measures.

Another category of policies focuses on mesoeconomic factors, distinguished between industries and regions (Vlados et al., 2019). These policies, which were popular mostly in the earlier decades, notably in the 1960s, 1970s, and 1980s, were trying to stimulate entrepreneurship by incentivizing specific “strategic” industries (OECD, 2009a). Traditional regional development policies, such as growth poles, belong to these mesoeconomic approaches to stimulating entrepreneurship (Parr, 1999). These policies are usually top-down, giving subsidies and “tax relief” to specific regions. Therefore, while “macro-policies” concern horizontal measures, “meso-policies” are vertical and incorporate the industrial and spatial dimensions.

The third type of policy seems to start a long ago, but it is still not that extensive (Barreto, 2013). “Micro-policies” to strengthen entrepreneurship concern the support of the internal organizational environment (OECD, 2007). In this approach, the policy aims to improve the external environment by providing firms with consulting and mechanisms to understand and improve their inner structuration (Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2020b). The aim is to inform and offer in-business training to improve the firm’s innovative and competitive potential.

In recent years, scholarly literature discusses and enriches these concepts by introducing the “micro-meso” dimension, efficient nowadays due to the globalization of industries and the parallel emergence of enterprises that manage to create sophisticated knowledge internally. In other words, the micro-meso level concerns the business that thinks and acts in terms of “glocalization,” targeting the innovative firm that changes the global environment while living in its local environment (Carayannis & von Zedtwitz, 2005; Cecilia de Burgh-Woodman, 2014). In the micro-meso approach, a

fundamental contribution is that of clusters and business ecosystems, concerning the spatial and industrial contour together with the peculiarity and “physiology” of the firm, which shapes its hosting environment with its action (Iansiti & Levien, 2004; Lazzeretti et al., 2014; Vlado & Chatzinikolaou, 2020a). Vlado and Chatzinikolaou (2019a) suggest a micro-meso level and business ecosystems policy for the Greek regions, which can enrich our understanding of how to support entrepreneurship and innovation (Figure 2).

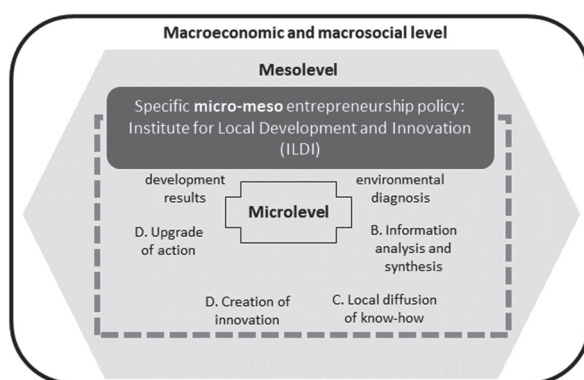


Figure 2. The micro-meso policy proposal of ILDI (Institute for Local Development and Innovation). An adjustment from Vlado and Chatzinikolaou (2019a)

The authors argue that the Greek regions need to build this mechanism that could link and coordinate, as an intermediate organization, local government, industry, and academia (Altaf et al., 2018). These Institutes of Local Development and Innovation (ILDI) can be organizations that collect data from their internal and external environment to offer free consulting services to local businesses, following a six-step cycle: environmental diagnosis, analysis and synthesis of information, local diffusion of knowledge, creation of innovation, upgrade of action, and monitoring of development results.

4. Conclusions and prospects

This paper showed that the micro-meso and macrolevel are the two principal domains of policy nowadays, attributing to the micro-meso level the

primary significance for today's entrepreneurship policies. In the micro-meso, the government should foster business innovation by offering policy mechanisms that connect different socio-economic actors. It is not by chance that the European heads of states, considering the recent COVID-19 outbreak, call for a regulatory environment and state aid framework that favors innovation and new private investments and eases entrepreneurs' innovative involvement (European Council, 2020).

In conclusion, highlighting practical problems at the policy level using this micro-meso and macrolevel filter can be the first step in formulating and articulating specific entrepreneurship enhancement policies depending on the system under consideration. This approach can function as a diagnostic mechanism for finding the comparative weaknesses at the policy level, suggesting relevant directions after studying best practices. Another policy area likely to be of research interest is the integrated and multilevel industrial policy at the "micro-meso-macro" level (Peneder, 2017). In the future, we could examine whether there is a model for strengthening entrepreneurship between different sets of countries, for example, between the European North and South, since these are countries with structural asymmetries in economic and social terms (Szerb et al., 2013).

References

- Altaf, A., Hassan, I. e, & Batool, S. (2018). The role of ORIC in the evolution of the triple helix culture of innovation: The case of Pakistan. *Technology in Society*, 56, 157–166. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techsoc.2018.09.014>
- Barreto, H. (2013). *The entrepreneur in microeconomic theory: Disappearance and explanation*. London: Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203060599>
- Bianchi, P., & Labory, S. (2012). Conceptualisations, relationships and trends between innovation, competitiveness and development: Industrial policy beyond the crisis. In P. Cooke, M. D. Parrilli, & J. L. Curbelo (Eds.), *Innovation, global change and territorial resilience* (pp. 295–312). Cheltenham, UK; Northampton, MA: Edward Elgar; Scopus. <https://doi.org/10.4337/9780857935755.00023>
- Burnes, B. (2009). *Managing change: A strategic approach to organisational dynamics*. Harlow, UK; New York, US: Prentice Hall/Financial Times.

- Carayannis, E. G., & von Zedtwitz, M. (2005). Architecting gloCal (global–local), real-virtual incubator networks (G-RVINS) as catalysts and accelerators of entrepreneurship in transitioning and developing economies: Lessons learned and best practices from current development and business incubation practices. *Technovation*, 25(2), 95–110. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0166-4972\(03\)00072-5](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0166-4972(03)00072-5)
- Cecilia de Burgh-Woodman, H. (2014). Homogeneity, “glocalism” or somewhere in between?: A literary interpretation of identity in the era of globalization. *European Journal of Marketing*, 48(1/2), 288–313. <https://doi.org/10.1108/EJM-03-2011-0132>
- Crossan, M. M., & Apaydin, M. (2010). A multi-dimensional framework of organizational innovation: A systematic review of the literature. *Journal of Management Studies*, 47(6), 1154–1191. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1467-6486.2009.00880.x>
- Dopfer, K., Foster, J., & Potts, J. (2004). Micro-meso-macro. *Journal of Evolutionary Economics*, 14(3), 263–279. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00191-004-0193-0>
- European Council. (2020). Special meeting of the European Council (17, 18, 19, 20 and 21 July 2020) –Conclusions. Brussels: Belgium.
- Geus, A. de. (2002). *The living company*. Boston, MA: Harvard Business School Press.
- Howlett, M. (2009). Governance modes, policy regimes and operational plans: A multi-level nested model of policy instrument choice and policy design. *Policy Sciences*, 42(1), 73–89. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11077-009-9079-1>
- Iansiti, M., & Levien, R. (2004). *The keystone advantage: What the new dynamics of business ecosystems mean for strategy, innovation, and sustainability*. Boston, MA: Harvard Business School Press.
- Lazzeretti, L., Sedita, S. R., & Caloffi, A. (2014). Founders and disseminators of cluster research. *Journal of Economic Geography*, 14(1), 21–43. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jeg/lbs053>
- Mirzanti, I. R., Simatupang, T. M., & Larso, D. (2015). Entrepreneurship policy implementation model in Indonesia. *International Journal of Entrepreneurship and Small Business*, 26(4), 399–415. <https://doi.org/10.1504/IJESB.2015.072765>
- Nonaka, I., & Takeuchi, H. (1995). *The knowledge-creating company: How Japanese companies create the dynamics of innovation*. New York, US: Oxford University Press. [https://doi.org/10.1016/0024-6301\(96\)81509-3](https://doi.org/10.1016/0024-6301(96)81509-3)
- OECD. (2007). *Micro-policies for growth and productivity Summary of key findings*. Paris, France: OECD.
- OECD. (2009a). Competition policy, industrial policy and national champions. *Round-table on Competition Policy, Industrial Policy and National Champions*. Global Forum on Competition. <https://www.oecd.org/daf/competition/44548025.pdf>

- OECD. (2009b). *Policy responses to the economic crisis: Investing in innovation for long-term growth*. Paris, France: OECD.
- OECD. (2020). *E-commerce in the time of COVID-19* (Tackling Coronavirus (COVID-19): Contributing to a Global Effort). Secretary-General of the OECD. <http://www.oecd.org/coronavirus/policy-responses/e-commerce-in-the-time-of-covid-19-3a2b78e8/> [Accessed November 30th, 2020]
- Parr, J. B. (1999). Growth-pole strategies in regional economic planning: A retrospective view: Part 1. Origins and advocacy. *Urban Studies*, 36(7), 1195–1215. <https://doi.org/10.1080/0042098993187>
- Peneder, M. (2017). Competitiveness and industrial policy: From rationalities of failure towards the ability to evolve. *Cambridge Journal of Economics*, 41(3), 829–858. <https://doi.org/10.1093/cje/bew025>
- Porter, M. (Ed.). (1998). Rethinking competition: Creating tomorrow's advantages. In R. Gibson, *Rethinking the future: Rethinking business principles, competition, control & complexity, leadership, markets and the world* (pp. 48–61). London, UK: Nicholas Brealey.
- Schmookler, J. (1952). The changing efficiency of the American economy, 1869–1938. *The Review of Economics and Statistics*, 34(3), 214–231. <https://doi.org/10.2307/1925628>
- Schumpeter, J. (1934). *The theory of economic development: An inquiry into profits, capital, credit, interest, and the business cycle* (R. Opie, Trans.; Reprint Edition: New Brunswick, N.J., Transaction Books, 1983, Social science classics series). Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press.
- Schumpeter, J. (1942). *Capitalism, socialism and democracy* (Edition published in the Taylor&Francis e-Library, 2003). New York, US; London, UK: Harper & Brothers.
- Sloman, J. (2019). *Economics for business*. London, UK; New York, US: Pearson.
- Szerb, L. A., Acs, Z., & Autio, E. (2013). Entrepreneurship and policy: The national system of entrepreneurship in the European Union and in its member countries. *Entrepreneurship Research Journal*, 3(1), 9–34. <https://doi.org/10.1515/erj-2012-0010>
- United Nations. (2020). *Global Humanitarian Response Plan: COVID-19* (United Nations Coordinated Appeal: April – December 2020). <https://www.unocha.org/sites/unocha/files/Global-Humanitarian-Response-Plan-COVID-19.pdf> [Accessed November 30th, 2020]
- Vlados, Ch. (2016). *Στρατηγική μικρομεσαίων επιχειρήσεων σε συνθήκες κρίσης: Η προσέγγιση Stra.Tech.Man [Strategy of small and medium-sized enterprises: The Stra.Tech.Man approach]*. Athens: Kritiki Publications.

- Vlados, Ch. (2019a). Change management and innovation in the “living organization”: The Stra.Tech.Man approach. *Management Dynamics in the Knowledge Economy*, 7(2), 229–256. <https://doi.org/10.25019/MDKE/7.2.06>
- Vlados, Ch. (2019b). Porter’s diamond approaches and the competitiveness web. *International Journal of Business Administration*, 10(5), 33–52. <https://doi.org/10.5430/ijba.v10n5p33>
- Vlados, C., & Chatzinikolaou, D. (2019a). Business ecosystems policy in Stra.Tech.Man terms: The case of the Eastern Macedonia and Thrace region. *Journal of Entrepreneurship, Management and Innovation*, 15(3), 163–197. <https://doi.org/10.7341/20191536>
- Vlados, Ch., & Chatzinikolaou, D. (2019b). Crisis, institutional innovation and change management: Thoughts from the Greek case. *Journal of Economics and Political Economy*, 6(1), 58–77. <https://doi.org/10.1453/jepe.v6i1.1854>
- Vlados, Ch., & Chatzinikolaou, D. (2020a). From growth poles and clusters to business ecosystems dynamics: The ILDI counterproposal. *International Journal of World Policy and Development Studies*, 6(7), 115–126. <https://doi.org/10.32861/ijwpds.67.115.126>
- Vlados, Ch., & Chatzinikolaou, D. (2020b). Macro, meso, and micro policies for strengthening entrepreneurship: Towards an integrated competitiveness policy. *Journal of Business & Economic Policy*, 7(1), 1–12. <https://doi.org/10.30845/jbep.v7n1a1>
- Vlados, Ch., Deniozos, N., Chatzinikolaou, D., & Digkas, A. (2019). From traditional regional analysis to dynamics of local development: Foundations and theoretical reorientations. *International Journal of Regional Development*, 6(1), 1–38. <https://doi.org/10.5296/ijrd.v6i1.14230>
- World Economic Forum. (2020). *The future of jobs report*. Switzerland: World Economic Forum.